

THENI DISTRICT

The Hidden Paradise of Tamil Nadu

Geography & Landscape

Theni District is located in the southern part of Tamil Nadu, nestled at the foot of the Western Ghats. Bounded by the Idukki district of Kerala to the West and Madurai to the East, it is famously known for the fertile Cumbum Valley. The district is a land of mountains, rivers, and lush greenery.

Major Rivers

Vaigai and Mullaiperiyar supply water for vast irrigation networks.

Climate

Sub-tropical in plains; Temperate/Cool in hill stations like Meghamalai.

Forest Cover

Approx. 41% of the district is covered by dense forests and hills.

Headquarters

Theni-Allinagaram serves as the administrative center.

Agricultural Economy

Theni is an agrarian powerhouse. It is often called the **"Cardamom City"** (Bodinayakanur) and the **"Grapes City"** (Cumbum).

- **Cardamom:** Bodinayakanur is a global hub for cardamom trade.
- **Grapes:** Cumbum Valley produces black grapes throughout the year.
- **Mangoes:** Periyakulam is famous for high-yield mango varieties.
- **Cash Crops:** Significant production of Coffee, Tea, and Cotton.

Tourism Highlights

Known as the "Gateway to Tourism," Theni offers diverse destinations ranging from waterfalls to hill stations.

Meghamalai (High Wavy Mountains)

An eco-tourism spot known for tea estates, waterfalls, and a cool climate. It is home to rare species of flora and fauna.

Suruli Falls

A famous 150-foot waterfall. According to legend, the falls are mentioned in the Tamil epic 'Silappathikaram'.

Vaigai Dam

Built across the Vaigai river, this dam is a major picnic spot with a well-maintained garden called 'Little Brindavan'.

Demographic Data

Metric	Detail
Total Area	2,868 Sq. Km
Literacy Rate	77.26% (Approx)
Primary Language	Tamil
Major Taluks	Theni, Bodi, Periyakulam, Uthamapalayam, Andipatti
Connectivity	National Highway 45 is the primary lifeline.

Culture & Traditions

The district is rich in cultural heritage. The **Veerapandi Gowmariamman Temple** festival is one of the most celebrated events in the region, drawing thousands of devotees during the Chithirai month.